

Bluff

YOUR WAY THROUGH

Web 2.0 Gibberish

If you ever want to pass yourself off as a technology analyst, Web 2.0 is your best friend—nobody knows what it even means! All we *really* know is that it's about social surfing and other such touchy-feely nonsense. Surf with your friends! Tell them what you liked, and make them like it! Create new buzzwords!

Folksonomy

The new Taxonomy—while organisations decided categories for content in Web 1.0, the task is now offloaded onto the masses. Better known as: “You filed that picture under *what*???”

Tagging

The act of contributing to a folksonomy. Better known as “I think I’ll categorise this Web page as ‘l33t’, ‘uber-cool’ and ‘hot stuff’”

Mashup

A collection of services, all “mashed up” into one. Better known as “I have a Web site that lets you view YouTube videos when you click the places I vacationed in, on Google Maps!”

Rich Internet Application (RIA)

A pretty, more user-friendly version of the same sites you see today, so more people will visit them. Better known as “Ooooh! Did you see the way that menu came down?”

AJAX

Asynchronous JavaScript and XML—the Great Enabler of the RIA. No Web 2.0 conversation should pass without at least 20 mentions, one of which should be “I’ve put AJAX on my site”, even if all that AJAX does is print “Hello World” on the page.

Finally, the best way to get them to believe you is to string these words together in random order. For a handy guide, refer to the Web 2.0 Bullshit Generator—bullshit—at <http://emptybottle.org/bullshit>

Now go out there and share dynamic ad-delivery!

Wild Wild Web

London Burning

We learnt about this one late—it happened on the 16th of August: London had hit an all-time-high temperature of a titanium-melting 1,777 degrees C on that fateful day. Funny thing: we never heard about people dying, or about Tower Bridge melting, or anything of the sort.

So now we *know* they should have elected Gore: he had a lot to say about global warming and such, while Bush is pretty happy hacking down forests in Alaska. If you’ve heard about the butterfly effect (we told you about it in the August issue), you’ll know that such things can have worldwide repercussions.

Or was there a hole in the ozone layer *just* above London, through which the sun shone, umm, a little brighter? Or perhaps the thermometer just went kaput at the time of the reading? Or perhaps the BBC just screwed up on its Internet ticker? No, that can’t be. If the BBC said it, it must be true. Refer ticker below.

Irwin Dead, But Up For Sale

This isn’t about an eBay auction, but rather about a gaffe on the part of Google’s bots. These bots have a tendency to make interesting little goof-ups, some of which you might have noticed: go a site that has information on spam,



and you’ll see “Best deals on spam! Click here!” (Now it’s got to be one seriously lobotomised individual that’ll *pay* for spam.) Anyway, the gaffe in question was this: someone in the UK typed in “irwin steve dead” into the Google search bar, and was presented with the following ad, as in the screenshot above: www.ebay.co.uk

Find Steve Irwin Dead! Buy Steve Irwin Dead on eBay

Bots do bungle, but this bit is too much for anyone to, umm, digest. Still, it’s the same bots that give us the Web—so let’s shut up and not complain.

As S***ty As It Gets

Not literally. We’re talking about a bronze cast of poop. It’s not any old poop, mind you: it’s the first-produced poop of the baby of Tom Cruise and Katie Holmes. Basic sensibilities pre-

vent us from reproducing a picture of the bronze cast, which went for sale on eBay.

Actually, baby poop isn’t that disgusting, especially for doting mothers. (For those of us who can’t be doting mothers, especially the men amongst us, it *is* disgusting.)

You can’t buy it, though. The auction ended September 9. Bummer.

BBC WEATHER 16 August 2006 • London: 1777C • Paris: 21C • Moscow: 24C

on top of his car, and then driving off, dropping it in the process; a freshly-fired IT manager kicking a server; the dropping of 120 barrels of crude oil on a laptop; and our favourite—the wife who chucked her husband’s laptop down a well!

We wonder how Disklabs’ employees ever get any work done with all these gems floating around. One thing’s for sure—we’d all love to be on their mailing lists!

TERRORISTS BEWARE

The War Against Terror

In the past few years, major terrorist attacks around the world have

changed us into a paranoid bunch. It’s not just on airplanes, trains and buses that we’re apprehensive, and being security checked by policemen is pretty much standard. But getting into your mobile and PC? Now that’s unacceptable!

Just how paranoid are we? Let’s find out:

Gentag, a mobile hardware developer, has been awarded a patent for sensors in mobile devices that warn the owner about toxic fumes in the vicinity. This is how Gentag hopes to warn people of an impending chemical weapon attack.

Of course, this is just a patent, and not a product, so there’s time before your watch, mobile or PDA will start going crazy if someone left the gas on in the house!

Then there’s the study

that discovered that a certain type of sunfish, mainly found in North America, is very sensitive to toxins in the water. So what they’re doing over there in the US is keeping a tank of these fish, and constantly changing the water in the tank using the municipal’s water supply. This way, if there’s an attack that involves poisoning or polluting drinking water, the fish will show the symptoms. And you thought that fish were only good for food...

You would think that, by now, there would be some cool gadget that did the same thing, more accurately, and without harming innocent fish! It seems we’re going backwards in time to the days when miners carried canaries in cages down